Chapter 18

Impacts of Globalization on Groups in Society

Chapter Focus

Does globalization empower individuals and groups around the world? Supporters of globalization might point out international organizations such as **UNICEF** (the United Nations Children's Fund) that work to empower groups such as children and youth by improving their quality of life. Another position is that globalization has weakened individuals and groups. Supporters of the negative position might point out the serious areas of concern for groups such as women who work in globalized industries. These women are often underpaid and at physical risk.

Exploring the challenges and opportunities presented to individuals and groups by globalization should help you address the Main Issue for Part 4: ***Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization?***

Chapter Issue

In this chapter, you will have a chance to explore different perspectives on the extent to which globalization has empowered individuals and groups such as children and youth and women. You will look at examples of the challenges and opportunities globalization presents, particularly in the area of human rights. These examples will help you explore the following Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?***

UNICEF United Nations Children's Fund

Key Terms

UNICEF
hypothetical
civilian
refugee
IDP
gender
grassroots organization
advocacy
migrant worker
entrepreneur

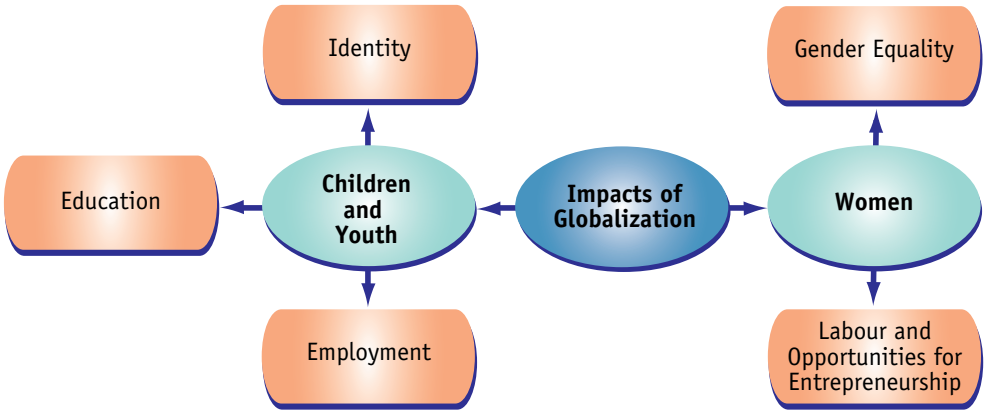


Figure 18-1 As you read about these topics in this chapter, think about why the effects of globalization on children, youth, and women should concern you.

SP Thinking Like a Geographer

Conduct a Geographic Investigation

SKILL PATH

Geographers are interested in figuring out how people, places, and environments affect each other locally, regionally, and globally. One of the purposes may be to answer questions such as the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?*** By using geographic skills you can

- collect and analyze information
- reach an informed conclusion
- decide on a fitting course of action

Your Task: In this Skill Path, you will have a chance to explore how globalization has affected a specific group—in this case, children and youth or women—in a specific country. You will then use this information to decide how globalization might be used to further empower this group. Decide the following:

a) what country you want to focus on

b) whether you want to focus on children and youth or on women

Then follow the steps in the Skill Path to conduct a geographic inquiry into the empowerment of children and youth or women in your country of choice.

READING GUIDE

As you are researching, look for data that reveal the level of empowerment of the group you are studying. For example, you might look at school enrollment, standard of living, and the number of women in positions of power.

Step 1

Ask Questions

Being a successful geographer requires the ability to ask, think about, and answer questions about how things are in a particular place and why they are that way. Begin your task in this Skill Path by asking the following questions:

a) Where is the country you chose in relation to where you live?

b) What is its population?

c) What percentage of the population is male and what percentage is female? Or what is the average age?

d) What is the average level of education in the population?

e) What is the ratio of doctors to population? Or what is the average life expectancy?

f) What are the country's major natural resources or industries?

g) To what extent is the country industrialized?

Step 2

Acquire Geographic Information

Now you need to find information related to the effects of globalization on the group that you are studying. This includes both the physical and human features of the country and the impact these have on youth and children or women. Begin by gathering information from different sources. Consider using maps, textbooks, and news reports.

a) What are the main *physical* characteristics of the country, such as its natural resources? What impact do they have on individuals and communities?

b) What are the main *human* characteristics? For example, what is the country's main industry, and what countries are its trading partners?

c) In what ways have human activities had an impact on the physical environment?

d) Over time, what have been the effects of these human activities on the specific group you are studying?

Figure 18-2 The information you collect can be more easily managed if you divide it into categories. Try to think of more categories for visuals and text.

Categories for Visual Information	Categories for Written Information
photographs	interviews
aerial photographs	documents
graphs	quotations
climate graphs	statistics
maps	
diagrams	

Step 3

Organize Your Information

Once you have collected your information, you need to organize and display it in ways that will help you figure out what it means.

a) Separate the visual information into categories such as those listed in Figure 18-2. Prepare brief summaries highlighting the main points in each set of information.

b) Organize your written information into categories such as those listed in Figure 18-2. Summarize the key points in a chart or concept web.

Step 4

Analyze Your Information

When you analyze geographic information, look for patterns, relationships, and connections.

a) Examine maps to discover and compare patterns and relationships.

b) Study statistics and graphs to determine trends and relationships between and among data.

c) Examine written accounts to interpret, explain, and combine related information.

d) Identify similarities and patterns.

e) Think about what these similarities and patterns reveal about what you are studying.

Step 5

Reaching Conclusions

If you have completed a successful geographic inquiry, you should now be able to make generalizations and draw conclusions based on the information you have collected, organized, and analyzed. You should also be able to decide on a course of action.

a) What generalizations can you make about the role of the group you are studying in the country you are focusing on?

b) Has globalization led to the group's empowerment or has it reduced their level of power in their country?

c) What is the long-term impact of the patterns you have discovered?

d) Based on your findings, how could globalization be used to empower the specific group in the country you are studying?

Step 6

Present Your Findings

Display the information about the group and country you have investigated in a clear and interesting way. Possible options include:

- a multimedia presentation
- a visual display of photographs, maps, graphs, and text
- a news report with at least two visuals
- an essay with at least two visuals

Global Children and Youth: Challenges and Opportunities

Do you ever worry about your health or safety? Are you ever hungry? Do you know families who are? Do you have a job? These are all factors that affect your quality of life. What is Canada's role in protecting and advancing quality of life for children and youth in Canada and around the world?

Question for Inquiry

- **In what ways has globalization had an impact on children and youth?**

Canada determined to protect children

UNITED NATIONS—Canada has renewed its commitment to protecting children's rights and will donate $500 000 to a new international food program. ...

The Standard (St. Catharines), May 10, 2002

Chocolate's bitter legacy: profit on backs of children: Ivory Coast industry runs on child labour

News of a boat allegedly carrying a load of child slaves off the coast of West Africa has raised the issue of child labour on cocoa plantations that supply much of the chocolate sold in Canada. ...

Ottawa Citizen, April 18, 2001

Most likely, a major part of your identity is your age and gender. How old are you? Are you male or female? When you answer these questions, you include yourself in a specific group or community. You are included in data that are gathered and analyzed by country, by region, and globally. As a Canadian, you are embraced in Canadian, North American, and world data that indicate how many males and females there are in different age groups. The concerns that you have because of your age and gender may receive more attention because they are the concerns of a group, not an individual.

Through globalization you can learn more about where you stand as a member of different groups and communities. Communication between young people and adults has increased through the Internet. In addition, the international media shines the spotlight on areas of concern around the world.

Globalization of communications has led people from all over the world to work together for common causes through international organizations. International groups that promote human rights such as UNICEF, La Francophonie, and Street Kids International work to improve the quality of life of children. They feel that children have the right to a certain experience of childhood. They promote a particular identity for children: young people aged 1 through 18 who should have opportunities to play and go to school.

Can you identify with the vision of childhood that includes school and play? What should be protected as rights for children? Consider the following:

- Were you protected from the harsh realities of life? Or did you have to face difficult times?

Reading Guide

Think back to previous sections of the text when you come across familiar topics. For example, you began to consider the enormity of your cohort (age group) in the population pyramids on page 14.

Web Link

Follow the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website to find more information on UNICEF, Street Kids International, and the youth and sports branch of La Francophonie.

Figure 18-3 Many factors may affect how people experience childhood, including their culture, wealth, and family situations. How has globalization made us aware of the range of childhood experiences around the world?

hypothetical describes something that exists as a possibility, an unproven idea or theory

Reading Guide

When reading, ask yourself questions that cause you to think beyond the information in the text. For instance, instead of asking "Are international organizations such as UNICEF a positive effect of globalization?" ask yourself a *hypothetical* question, such as "What would I do if I were in charge of UNICEF?"

FastFacts

The 140 countries that have signed the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child are legally bound to protect the welfare of children within their borders. If they don't, they could face criminal charges at the International Criminal Court. Penalties range from paying the victims to serving jail time (if the violator is an individual). What challenges could you see in bringing an offending country to court?

- Were you cared for and encouraged to experiment within the safety of your home and school? Or did you have too much time on your hands?
- Did you maintain the role of "child" in your family? Or did you take on a caregiver role by caring for yourself, your siblings, or your parents or guardians?
- Did you play every day after school? Or did your work life begin early, in the form of chores at home, on the farm, or in your neighbourhood? Did you seek paid work when you moved into your teen years?

Millions of children and youth worldwide do not experience those things that are widely considered to be their rights. Their lives are focused on daily survival. They are denied shelter against danger and violence and do not have the time and resources to play and go to school. They cope without many of the things most Canadians take for granted. Food, clean water, and basic medical care are rarely seen "luxuries." Children in need can be found in every country, including Canada.

The rights of children and youth around the world are protected by the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child, which came into force in 1990. The rights listed in the Convention can be organized into four main areas of concern:

- Guiding Principles, such as the right to non-discrimination
- Survival and Development Rights, such as rights to food, shelter, clean water, formal education, health care, and recreation
- Protection Rights, such as protection from all forms of abuse, neglect, exploitation, and cruelty
- Participation Rights, such as the right to information and to associate with whomever they wish

On the following pages, you will have a chance to focus on children's rights with respect to war, labour, and education as you take the first steps in considering the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?***

The Impacts of War on Children and Youth

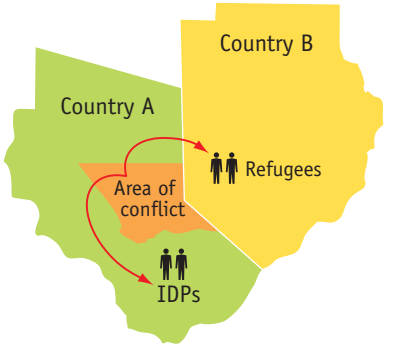
Armed conflicts affect the development of youth and children in many places in the world. In 2002, more than 30 countries were actively using children under the age of 18 as soldiers. In Afghanistan, Burundi, Columbia, Congo, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Myanmar, Pakistan, Sierra Leone, Sri Lanka, and Uganda, children as young as 8 years of age were serving as soldiers in rebel groups and national armed forces.

The reasons that children and youth serve as soldiers vary. In some cases, their governments may force them to serve; in other cases they may have been kidnapped from their families by rebel groups. Some children join armies to escape poverty that, in certain cases, was caused when their parents lost their jobs in a globalized economy. The globalization of trade in inexpensive weapons has provided plastic guns that are lightweight and easy for children to carry and use. This had led to a larger number of children being armed and committing violent acts.

Yet even if children and youth are not serving as soldiers, they are placed at risk by armed conflict. The rate of death and injury to **civilians** has increased to more than 90 per cent of all casualties. Wars are now more life-threatening to civilians, including children and youth, than to the soldiers who fight them.

In many cases, families attempt to save their children from harm by fleeing to neighbouring countries or to a safer area within their own country. People who flee to another country are called **refugees**. Those who flee within their own country are called internally displaced persons (**IDPs**). As you read the Global Connections feature that follows, think about the lives of refugee children and consider the Question for Inquiry: *In what ways has globalization had an impact on children and youth?*

civilian a citizen who is not a member of a country's military force



refugee a person who flees his or her home by escaping to another country

IDP internally displaced person

FastFacts

In 2005, more than half of an estimated 20 million refugees and displaced persons around the world were children.

What events might cause you to leave your homeland, temporarily or permanently?

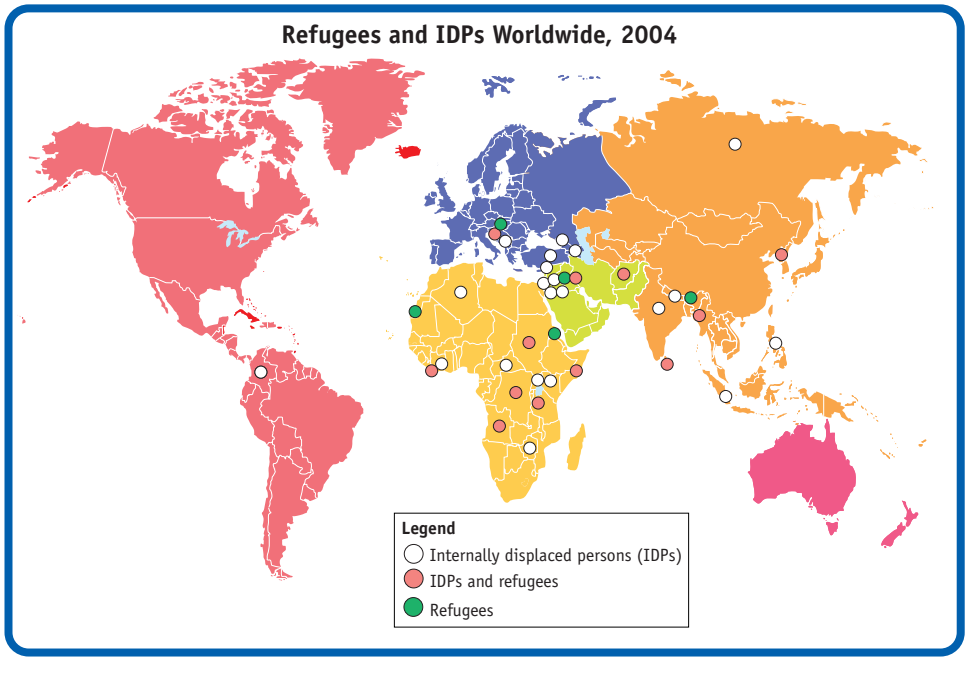


Figure 18-4 This map shows where refugee and IDP populations number more than 100 000. Take a close look at each continental area on this map. Which regions seem to have the most refugees and IDPs? How would a map like this help organizations figure out which areas require the most international assistance?

Global Connections

Children as Refugees and IDPs

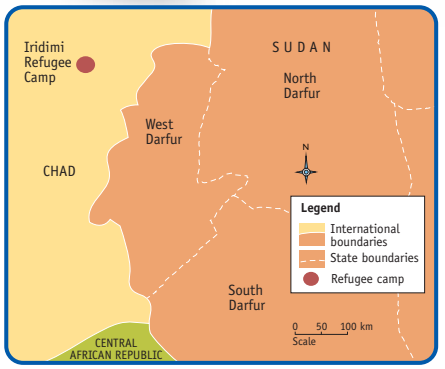


Figure 18-5 Iridimi Refugee Camp in Chad

The movement of millions of adults and children who have fled their homelands is one aspect of global migration. It shows the increasing connections between the world's populations caused by globalization.

Experts often state that the more globalized a country is, the more open its borders are to those seeking safety and security. People in war zones often seek refuge in neighbouring countries because they are physically close. This creates a high demand for humanitarian assistance—shelter, food, medical facilities, safety, and security. This aid is usually provided by the host nation and, if available, international relief organizations such as the Red Cross and Red Crescent.

The experience of refugees is described here by 11-year-old Fatouma, who fled with her family to Chad from Sudan when her village was attacked. Adolphe Mbaikouma Thomtet, who works for UNICEF, also comments on what he has seen.

"It is like a prison and it is not home," she [Fatouma] says of life in Iridimi camp, where she and her family have been living among nearly 15 000 refugees since they fled the Darfur region of western Sudan over a year ago. …

Adolphe Mbaikouma Thomtet, UNICEF's protection officer in Iridimi, works with children in the camp every day. Himself a former refugee, he can detect the suffering behind their broad smiles and the "SOS call" behind their laugh.

"At first, you don't see the difference between a young Sudanese refugee and another child in Chad because they look alike and wear the same worn-out clothes," he says. "But when you look closer, the refugee children will tell you about their suffering and fears. They don't know why they are refugees and have to live in a camp. They constantly fear attacks by armed militia, they are afraid of the wind beating against the tent at night. And they all say the same thing: 'We want to go home, back to Darfur. We want to see our house, our friends.'"

Source: Ginette Le Breton, "Growing Up in a Refugee Camp", *UNHCR News Stories*, August 2, 2005, http://www.unhcr.org/cgi-bin/texis/vtx/news/opendoc.htm?tbl=NEWS&id=42ef92c77.

Figure 18-6 Refugees escaping conflict in Sudan have fled to refugee camps such as this one in Chad. These camps provide housing, shelter from the elements, and some food. Think of how the lives of these children may have changed when they became refugees.

Refugee camps are usually established along the borders of states. Although they are meant to offer temporary shelter until the violence is over and refugees can return to their homelands, these camps can become the permanent homes of refugees.

1. ***Consider It.*** Why do you think Fatouma says that the refugee camp is like a prison?
2. ***Explain It.*** Explain why increased globalization in a country may lead it to accept more refugees.
3. ***Discuss It.*** Do you think refugee camps allow individuals and groups such as children and youth to become empowered? Why or why not?

Employed Children and Youth

Have you ever had a job outside your home, for example, babysitting or delivering papers? How were you treated on these jobs? Did your employer treat you fairly and provide you with reasonable pay? For many children and youth working in the world, this isn't always the case.

Globalization has increased economic competition. To give themselves a lead in the global market, producers try to provide goods and services of value at the lowest possible prices. To do this, some producers employ children and youth. Here are some of the reasons why children may be hired before adults:

- Children work for lower wages.
- They are too young to protest against unsafe working conditions.
- They are easy to exploit because they don't have experience.
- In some societies, children are expected to work.

Some children and youth work in the home and in the fields as part of growing up. They are cared for, treated fairly, and able to go to school. In poor families it is understood that everyone has to work. In middle-class or wealthier families, young family members may like to work in order to afford more luxuries.

There are many children, though, who suffer from their work. They may experience any or all of the following:

- long hours without enough nutrition and care
- abuse from their employers
- no chance to go to school
- for those children who do go to school, lower levels of academic success and dropping out at a young age to pursue other low-paying jobs

Children who are exploited rarely have the opportunity to develop literacy or skills that would help them get better jobs. As a result, international organizations such as UNICEF focus on providing these children with an education. The relationship between education and globalization is explored in the next section.

Active Citizen

Have you ever wondered, as you put on your sneakers, what life might be like for the person who made them? High-profile companies like Nike set minimum standards for working conditions in factories that produce their goods. List five rules you would use if you were working for a store that wanted to make sure its products come from companies that treat workers fairly. Consider wages, working hours, job security, and so on.

Education

As you learned in Chapter 3, the global knowledge economy has increased the value of learning throughout the world. The authors of a 2005 report titled "Measuring Globalization" state that "shifting to a globalized

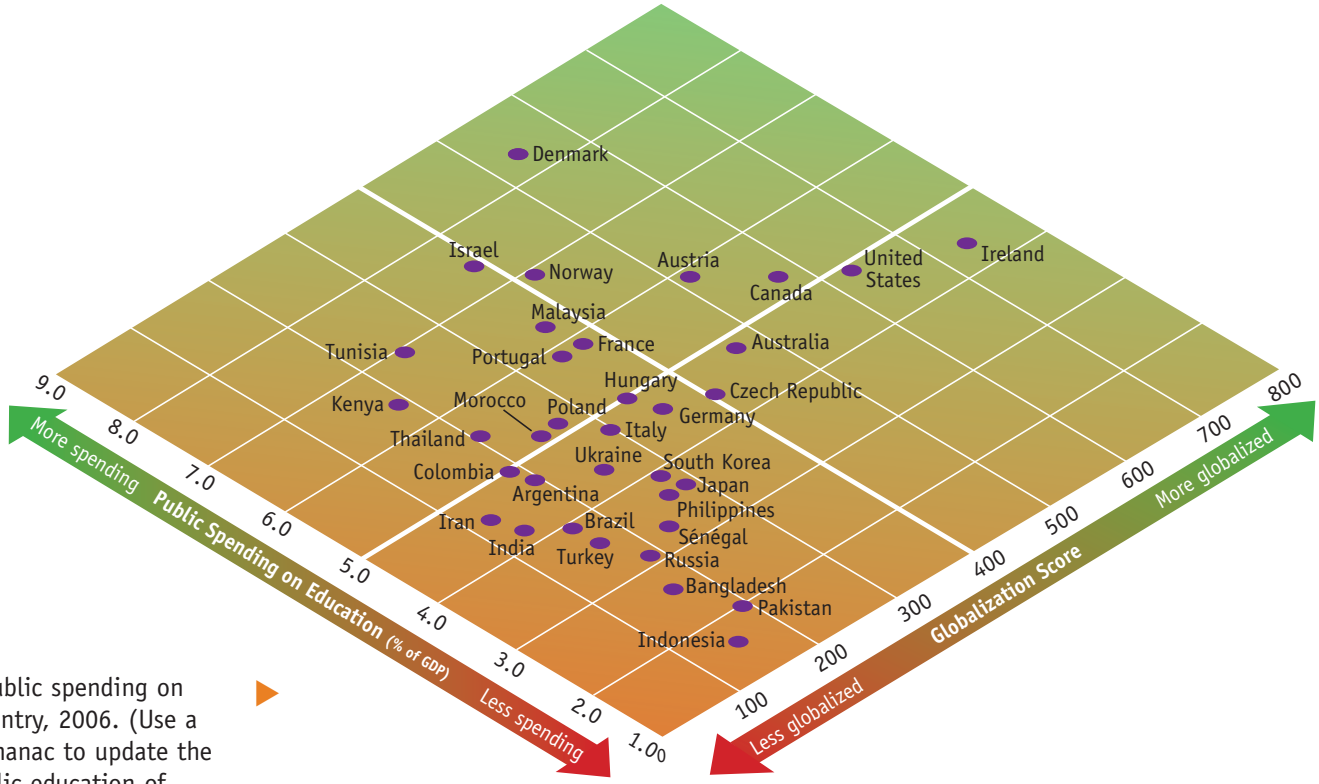
FastFacts

In 2004, about 250 million children between the ages of 5 and 14 were working in jobs that ranged from farming to factory work to prostitution.

Do you think children should be permitted to work at all? If so, what type of work should they do?

Figure 18-7 A Filipino boy listens to speakers at a 1998 anti-child labour rally in suburban Quezan City, Philippines. The poster was made by the International Labour Organization, whose motto is "Promoting decent work for all." What posters can you find in your school and community that promote the interests of children and youth? On what topics do they focus?

economy means that an educated population is not just desirable but essential." Most experts agree that workers in the global economy have to be more experienced and better educated than ever before. They also have to be able to adjust easily to new ideas, technologies, and changes in the workplace. The link between globalization and spending on public education is illustrated in Figure 18-8.



Source: A.T. Kearney, 2006, http://www.atkearney.com/shared_res/pdf/2005G-index.pdf.

Figure 18-8 Public spending on education by country, 2006. (Use a current world almanac to update the spending on public education of 10 of these countries.) An educated workforce can help propel the process of globalization. Globalization, in some cases, may be able to increase education levels. Are there countries that spend a large percentage of annual GDP on education but are described in the graph as "less globalized"? Are there countries that spend little on education but appear on the graph as "more globalized"? Suggest possible reasons why these countries don't fit the pattern.

The United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child guarantees children's right to education, stating that primary education must be "compulsory and available free to all." Secondary education, including job skills, must be "available and accessible to every child," with the eventual introduction of free secondary education. While primary education for all might appear to be a clear and achievable global goal, in 2004, 121 million children were still denied this right.

As you learned earlier, large numbers of young people cannot get an education, either because they live in unstable environments or because they need to work. Also, in cities, many children living in slums or shantytowns or on the street are not allowed to attend school because their families do not own property or pay taxes. There are places, however, where globalization has led to educational opportunities. Read the Voices feature that follows and think about the effects of globalization on education to help answer the Question for Inquiry: *In what ways has globalization had an impact on children and youth?*

Voices

Learning Today for Tomorrow

In many traditional societies, girls do not go to school. Education is reserved for boys. Children and youth who do not attend school can find work in only the lowest paying jobs. There are children, though, whose opportunities for education are increasing in a globalized world.

Every day at 8 a.m., her straight black hair tied neatly in a braid, 16-year-old Neelam Aggarwal rides three miles to school in a horse-drawn buggy. She would like to be a doctor someday. But for girls like Neelam, who lives in the dusty, impoverished village of Farah in India's northern state of Uttar Pradesh, such a vocation seems remote. For starters, her school—like most village schools in India—doesn't even offer science classes for girls. But Neelam, one of eight daughters of a sweets maker, has no intention of becoming a housewife even if she doesn't get that medical degree.

"I want to make something of myself,'" she says. So each day after school, Neelam operates what amounts to the village's only public telephone—a cellular phone owned by Indian cellular operator Koshika. By charging her fellow villagers to make calls, Neelam can make as much as $25 on a really good day. She's saving the money for computer classes, which she hopes will lead to a good job.

Ten years ago, few girls in India would have dared to be like Neelam. But today, she is the very embodiment of the Indian youth—ambitious, technology-oriented, and confident. Her generation is the product of … an economy where free markets play a much bigger role. Indian society also has been transformed by the Internet and cable television—forces young people are best equipped to exploit.

Source: Manjeet Kripalani, "Economics: India's Youth: Capitalist Generation," *Business Week*, November 10, 1999.

1. How has education affected Neelam Aggarwal's personal identity?
2. a) Why do you think girls like Neelam Aggarwal had difficulty obtaining an education in the past?
   b) What obstacles still seem to exist for them?
3. How can globalization help Neelam and her peers achieve their goals?

Explore the Issues

1. ***Discuss and Decide.*** To complete this activity, use the skills you learned in the Chapter 4 Skill Path (pages 55–56) about working as a team.
   a) In a small group, rank the rights presented on page 303 in order of importance.
   b) Decide what rights international organizations should concentrate on promoting over the next year.
   c) Present your decisions, and the reasons supporting them, to the class.
2. ***Formulate Questions and Discuss.***
   a) Choose one of the topics discussed in this section:
      - United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child
      - the impacts of war on children and youth
      - child labour
      - education
   b) Pose three or four questions that connect the topic to your own experiences. For example, when considering child labour, you could ask questions such as "How can I find out which goods are produced by companies that exploit children?" and "Should I buy these products?"
   c) Share your questions with the class and use them as the basis for discussing the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?***

Globalization and Women

Globalization has affected women around the world in different ways. As you read this section, consider whether women seem to have made more gains or losses as a result of globalization.

Question for Inquiry

- **In what ways has globalization had an impact on women?**

Healing powers: African women are starting to take charge …

By Joshua Hammer (with Alexandra Polier in Kigali)

Women in at least a dozen African countries are breaking the male stranglehold on national legislatures, cabinets, courts, and other government institutions. They're making laws, changing attitudes, inspiring other women to follow them.

Newsweek, April 3, 2006

Activists highlight problems of poor women at World Social Forum in Venezuela

Activists at the massive World Social Forum turned their criticism Thursday to obstacles faced by poor women in Latin America, saying they are the main, often unheard, victims of globalization.

Canadian Press, January 26, 2006

How does globalization affect the basic rights of women? Are women's basic rights different from those of men? Do you think that everyone in the world would agree with you? What factors might cause opinions to differ?

Women's roles often reflect the beliefs and values of their societies. For example, in traditional villages in many Asian and African countries, female children are viewed as a burden to their families. Young girls leave their families at an early age to enter arranged marriages, so their parents do not provide them with a formal education, and the girls do not get the informal training provided by observing and helping their parents. Many of the women in these countries are affected by globalization as both men and women resist change that challenges traditions. In fact, globalization may increase the limits on women when societies take measures to ensure that their **gender** roles don't change.

There are places, though, where globalization has helped improve the quality of life for women in traditional villages through the work of international **advocacy** organizations. For example, in rural areas of Ghana, women and girls spent much of their time carrying water to their villages. Some girls even dropped out of school to have time to look for water. World Vision Ghana, a branch of the international organization World Vision, developed a project focused on bringing clean water and improved sewage systems to rural areas. The organizers involved local men *and* women. This project resulted in the education of more community members, improved health, and a deeper respect for women. Read ahead to explore more challenges and opportunities presented to women by globalization in order to address the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?***

gender female or male

advocacy active support for a cause or position

FastFacts

La Francophonie (see Chapter 4, page 60), is another international organization also committed to gender equality. In February 2000, members agreed to assess the organization's policies based on their impact on men and women at the Conference of Women of La Francophonie held in New Brunswick.

Consider why this agreement might be necessary.

Gender Equality in Politics

More than 50 per cent of the world's population is made up of women, but fewer than 10 per cent of the people serving in the highest levels of government are female. Some women have been elected to lead their countries. For example, in 2006, female presidents were elected in Liberia and Chile. More often, though, women in high-level government positions are responsible for education, health, and social welfare. Few women are given responsibility for finance, industry, or defence. Women have sought to gain a greater voice in political affairs through **grassroots organizations** and political campaigns. Why do you think a political voice is important to empower individuals and groups in a globalized world?

Globalization of communications and the media has made the world more aware of gender equality challenges. As you read the following pages, consider how globalization might be used as a tool to address these challenges on a local level, for example, by using foreign aid to train women who can be employed addressing local health concerns.

grassroots organization a community-based organization working on local projects

Web Link

Follow the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website to access WomenWatch, the UN Internet gateway on advancing and empowering women. Read about news highlights and recent and upcoming events.

Figure 18-9 In Iraq, women organized protests calling for women's rights in the country's 2005 constitution. For what reasons should women's rights receive particular attention in a country's constitution?

Globalization and Women's Labour

There are a variety of opinions about how a globalized economy has affected women's labour. One opinion is that globalization allows more workers to find employment in the branch plants and offices of foreign-owned firms. This work offers high pay and chances to advance that are not available in local businesses and industries. Another opinion is that most of the employment available for women is in low-skilled jobs, such as making clothing. This work is often low-paying with long working hours and difficult working conditions. A third opinion is that the effect of a globalized economy on women's labour has been mixed. By exploring concerns about women's labour you can make your own decision about the effects of economic globalization on women.

Reading Guide

Often you can expand your understanding of charts by making connections to material elsewhere in your textbook. Turn back to Part 1 and find connections to the crucial concerns summarized in Figure 18-10 on the next page. What do you already know that could be used as an example of each concern in this chart?

Crucial Concerns	Examples of Actions
Concern: Poverty • Women make up the majority of the world's poor. Among other reasons, this is a result of the low-paying jobs available to women, and the loss of jobs when factories close down due to global competition. **Potential Actions:** • Help individual women use financial services and resources. • Increase women's land ownership and property rights.	• To help reduce poverty, the non-profit organization Group for the Promotion of Education and Sustainable Development has successfully marketed purses that Mexican Indian women have created using recycled food packages.
Concern: Unpaid Labour • Domestic work is not recognized for its value to communities and societies. • In rural areas around the world, women are not paid for their labour growing food. **Potential Actions:** • Have governments equip women with skills to improve their economic and social status. • Promote and fund education for girls and women to allow them to participate freely in the information, education, and technology parts of their economies. • Encourage individual women to take part in educational opportunities.	• In areas of rural India, girls are being educated for the first time. Villagers are committed to hiring female teachers so that they can feel comfortable sending their older girls to school.
Concern: Sweatshop Labour • Globalization has led to increased employment of workers in producing goods for export, but they often earn low wages and have substandard working conditions. **Migrant workers**, in particular, are at risk since they are not citizens of the country in which they are working, and so they often do not have the protection of the government. **Potential Actions:** • Take legal action against manufacturers and retailers that exploit workers. • Expose abuses in the international media. • Stage international consumer boycotts whereby people choose not to buy products that are produced by exploited workers. • Pass international laws to promote and protect workers' labour rights. **migrant workers** a person who leaves his or her family and country to find work	• Individual and group activists opposed to "capitalist globalization"—that is, globalization that has profit-making as its central goal—protest regularly at meetings of world economic leaders to bring media attention to abuses of global workers.
Concern: Highly Competitive Globalized Marketplace • **Entrepreneurs** face competition from multinational companies that can offer quality goods and services at low prices. **Potential Actions:** • Provide women entrepreneurs with technical and financial support. • Increase training for women entrepreneurs, including the use of technology. • Entrepreneurs to provide guidance and advice to newcomers. **entrepreneur** a person who sets up or finances a new business or industry to make a profit	• The non-profit organization Women Entrepreneurs of Saskatchewan Inc. works with women who are considering starting or purchasing a business, or who are operating an existing business. They offer lending services, business: development workshops, and discussion groups to support women entrepreneurs.

Figure 18-10 Crucial concerns for women in the labour force

Global Geography

One task of human geography is to analyze how people are interconnected. For example, women around the world face many different challenges in attempting to work. Let's see how these challenges may be connected.

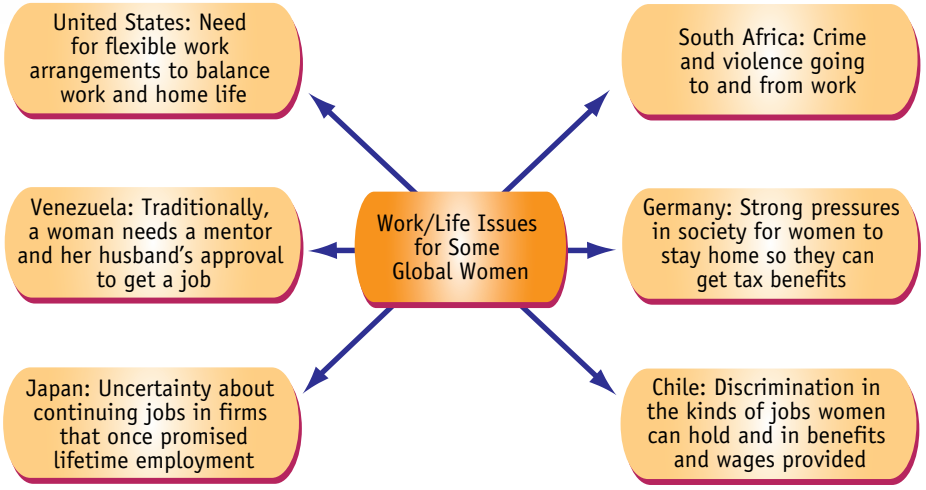


Figure 18-11 While the challenges of women who want to or have to work differ from country to country, they point to larger concerns that affect societies around the globe. Which of these challenges do you think is of greatest concern? Why? Which of these challenges causes you the least concern? Why?

1. For each of the countries listed in Figure 18-11, jot down how the challenge affects a woman's ability to work either inside or outside of the home. Now jot down how it affects her general quality of life. What pattern can you see?
2. For each challenge, consider how it affects men in the society. Write down how men may be affected positively or negatively. Then, list how they might be affected if the challenge were to be resolved in the women's favour.
3. The pressures and challenges of balancing work with other aspects of life have increased because of globalization. Businesses and industries are now operating in a 24-hour-a-day work world.
   a) How do you think it affects employees if a business has to operate around the clock?
   b) From what you have learned about the role of women from Figure 18-11, what makes this more of a challenge for women than for men?
   c) How would these challenges affect a single-parent family?
4. Use what you have learned by answering the questions above to discuss this section's Question for Inquiry: *In what ways has globalization had an impact on women?*

Opportunities for Entrepreneurship

International economic development projects used to attempt to involve women in grassroots level occupations that were traditional—crafts, clothing, and agriculture. As you learned in Part 3 of this textbook, foreign investors and international economic development agencies now support small businesses and market their goods and services globally. As you read the Voices feature that follows, think about the perspective of women entrepreneurs when considering the Question for Inquiry: *In what ways has globalization had an impact on women?*

FastFacts

According to the Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce, there are about 800 000 women entrepreneurs in Canada. Their numbers have increased 60 per cent faster than the growth in the number of male entrepreneurs since 1989. Would you want to be an entrepreneur? Why or why not?

Voices

An African Entrepreneur

Chigedze Chinyepi, a member of the American and African Business Women's Alliance and an entrepreneur, created a business employing 15 women full-time in the rural area in the Okavango Delta of northern Botswana. She also employs up to 50 women on a part-time basis. Her business involves weaving traditional baskets that are sold for export. Here are her comments on the challenges and the importance of efforts made in the support of women.

I produce through a full-time manufacturing set-up creating employment and alleviating [lessening] poverty for the workers. Shelter for these women consists of mud and grass houses, as they cannot afford to build expensive brick walls of cement. Only my supervisor managed to mould bricks at home and now has a single room with corrugated iron roof. The rest are just managing to buy food and clothing for the children and continue feeding the family, which in most cases extends over and above their own children. These are also elderly women, whose daughters and sons have died of HIV/AIDS, leaving so many children behind to be supported by the grandmothers. With an outlet in the US that will ensure a market for baskets, I could employ up to 50 women full-time.

Source: Source: Commission for Africa, *Our Common Interest*, 2005.

1. In what way does Chinyepi's business qualify as a "grassroots" business?
2. Using quotations from her comments, describe how the success of Chinyepi's business helps her community.
3. How would increased globalization benefit her business? Could globalization hurt her business at all?

Figure 18-12 Okavango Delta in northern Botswana

Explore the Issues

1. ***Be Creative.*** Use visual symbols to represent the impact of globalization on three topics that are discussed in this section. For instance, the topic of women entrepreneurs may include pictures of successful women entrepreneurs. Assemble your visuals into a photo album.
2. ***Research It.*** Using the research skills from the Skill Paths in Chapter 7 (pages 107–108) and Chapter 8 (pages 123–124), learn about the roles of Canadian Aboriginal women in their communities and around the world. You might research a national political leader such as Roberta Jamieson, or an entrepreneur such as Melanie Goodchild. You can begin your investigation by following the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website. Then write a brief biography about one of these Aboriginal women. Include a short description of how globalization has affected her life.
3. ***State Your Conclusion.*** Using what you learned in this section, write a short paragraph stating your conclusion about the extent to which globalization empowers individual women and groups of women in society.

Chapter Summary and Reflection

Apply and Extend Ideas

1 **a)** Begin this task by using the brainstorming techniques that you learned in the Chapter 1 Skill Path (pages 7–8). Working as a team, brainstorm a list of five child and youth topics that have not been discussed in this chapter. (Articles in newspapers and magazines may give you some ideas.) If the topic is a local one, determine how it may be connected to worldwide concerns. For example, while British Columbia and Alberta have dropped the minimum working age to 14, other Canadian provinces have not. Some countries have no minimum working age at all.

b) Use a keyword search to establish global trends. In investigating age of employment, you might use keywords such as "child labour" and "international standards for workers."

c) Form teams to develop a skit that presents two or more perspectives on one of these topics. For instance, a skit about minimum working age might present the views of an Alberta teen supporting herself independently, a parent, a team coach, and an employer.

Practise Your Skill

2 **a)** Follow the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website to explore two or three websites that discuss working conditions for women around the world.

b) Choose one location discussed in the websites and follow the steps from this chapter's Skill Path to collect and analyze information and complete a geographic inquiry. SKILL PATH

c) Use your analysis as the basis for deciding what course of action could be taken through globalization to improve the lives of working women in that location.

d) Design a T-shirt (made of construction paper or fabric) that describes the lives of working women in that area and how their lives might be improved through globalization. Include a map, two or three photographs or illustrations, and a quotation from a worker, employer, activist, or commentator.

e) Contribute your T-shirt to a "clothesline" strung around your classroom's walls.

Focus on Inquiry

3 Think about any geographic investigation you conducted in this chapter (e.g., in the Skill Path).

a) Evaluate your choice of country to research. Why did you choose it? Were you able to find enough information about it? Would you choose another next time? Explain.

b) Evaluate your sources for their usefulness in learning about physical geography.

c) Evaluate your sources for their usefulness in learning about human geography.

d) What geographic skills were the most difficult for you in this activity? How did you work to develop these skills to complete the activity?

Reflect on the Chapter Issue

In this chapter, you investigated the impacts of globalization on individuals and groups within society, such as children and youth, and women. You are now ready to respond to the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization empower individuals and groups in society?*** As a class, discuss and decide by consensus what individual or group activity you and your class could do to get the ideas flowing before you hold a class discussion about the Chapter Issue. To get you started, review the activities in the Reflect on the Chapter Issue sections, which appear at the very end of all the chapters in this book. This exploration will help you to continue to develop a personal point of view about the Main Issue for Part 4: ***Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization?***